Travel Quick Reference Guide

University of California - Policy G-28 Travel Regulations
UCSC Travel Guide
Types of Travel

Documentation/Substantiation: UCSC Travelers on University business typically pay for their expenses out of pocket or use a UCSC issued OneCard (employees) with reconciliation via Cruzfly or other formats based on affiliation. UC employees and students that do not hold a OneCard may seek an Instant Card. It is strongly recommended that travelers keep detailed records of how money is spent and obtain receipts whenever possible. Please review the links for reimbursable travel expenses vs. unallowable travel expenses before traveling.

Reporting Period: All travel expense claims must be submitted within 45 days after the end of the trip per policy. OneCard reconciliations submitted after 90 days will be reported as taxable income and applicable taxes will be withheld from the employee's paycheck.

Travel Policy - The following is selected information from UC Policy G-28, Travel Regulations						
TRAVEL CATEGORY	KEY RATES/LIMITS/GUIDELINES	RECEIPT REQUIREMENTS			SUBSTANTIATION REQUIREMENTS	OTHER INFORMATION
		Always	Over $75	Itemized		
Transportation						
Air Transportation	Coach/Economy Class	✓		✓	Itemized invoice provided by Airline or Travel Agency.	The University recommends booking airfare through the University of California **CONNEXXUS** Travel Portal (*See Note 1*).
Taxi, UBER, LYFT			✓			
Rental Car	Intermediate (not SUV) or Smaller Vehicle	✓		✓	Itemized Invoice provided by Agency.	The University recommends booking rental cars through the University of California **CONNEXXUS** Travel Portal.
Train, Bus, Share Ride	Coach/Economy Class		✓			
Personal Vehicle	72.5 cents per mile: January – June 30, 2026. 76 cents per mile – July – December 31, 2026.				Starting location, ending location, mileage by date.	Reimbursement is limited to the lesser of mileage or equivalent airfare/rental car cost with cost comparison documentation (*See Note 1*).
Lodging						
Lodging - Domestic	Maximum room rate - $333 per night before taxes/fees.	✓		✓	Itemized receipts including all charges.	If Room Rate > $333, then include: Lodging Limit Justification
Lodging - International (Actuals)	Reimbursement limited to the per diem lodging rate for the location and dates of travel (see – other info).	✓		✓	Itemized receipts including all charges.	Special or unusual circumstances need to be documented and substantiated with pre-authorization (p.27, UC G-28).
Non-Commercial Lodging		✓		✓		
Lodging - International (Per Diem)	Link to Dept of State Site					
Meals & Incidentals						
M&IE - Domestic	Actuals expense up to $92 per day unless sponsored by federal contract or grant. M&IE requires an overnight stay.		✓		Consider a daily log including date, meal and amount.	For possible receipt requirements (*See Note 2*). Alcohol not allowed unless under Entertainment policy.
M&IE - International (Actuals)	Actual expense up to 100% of Per Diem for Location/Time.		✓		Consider a daily log including date, meal and amount.	For possible receipt requirements (*See Note 2*). Alcohol not allowed unless under Entertainment policy.
M&IE - International (Per Diem)	Link to Dept of State Site					Alcohol not allowed unless under Entertainment policy.
Miscellaneous						
Host/Hostess Gift	$75 Maximum		$25		Receipt is required $25 or more.	One gift per stay.
Conference Registration Fees		✓		✓	Traveler must provide copy of Agenda.	Meals and Lodging Included with Conference fees *(See Note 3).*

Note 1 - Mixing Business and Personal Travel – compare and substantiate the lesser expense applicable per policy guidelines.

Airfare Cost Analysis: Step-by-Step Guide Example

Required for all travel involving a personal component.

1. Generate a Comparative Quote

At the time of booking, you must document the cost difference between **Business-Only** travel and **Mixed (Personal/Business)** travel.

- **Method:** Perform a search for all available flights on your travel dates.
- **Source:** Use **Connexxus** (Employees), **All available flight options from standard carriers** (Students & Non-UC Travelers).
- **The "Snapshot" Rule:** Print the full query results to show a range of the most economic, policy-compliant options available at time of booking. Do not just save a single fare.

2. Select the Most Economic Option

When determining the "Business-Only" baseline, prioritize the lowest cost to the University.

- **Layovers:** A minor layover of a few hours is expected if it results in significant savings.
- **Stewardship:** Choices must reflect a balance of cost, time, and benefit to the UCSC mission.

3. Get Pre-Approval

Before finalizing your purchase, review your cost analysis with your **Travel Expense Approver** or departmental office. They will confirm the specific amount eligible for reimbursement.

Note 2 - Receipts less than $75 - Departmental management and/or funding agencies may require more restrictive travel procedures and requirements, including requirements to provide original receipts for all M&IE regardless of amount.

Note 3 - Conference Fees may include Lodging and/or Food and should be considered when approving travel expense vouchers.